



Mark Scheme (Results)

Summer 2026

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE in

English Literature (4ET1)

Paper 1: Poetry and Modern Prose

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

Specific Marking Guidance

When deciding how to reward an answer, examiners should consult both the indicative content and the associated marking grid(s). When using a levels-based mark scheme, the 'best fit' approach should be used.

- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level.
- The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- Indicative content is exactly that – they are factual points that candidates are likely to use to construct their answer.
- It is possible for an answer to be constructed without mentioning some or all of these points, as long as they provide alternative responses to the indicative content that fulfils the requirements of the question. It is the examiner's responsibility to apply their professional judgement to the

candidate's response in determining if the answer fulfils the requirements of the question.

Placing a mark within a level

- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level. The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- In cases of uneven performance, the points above will still apply. Candidates will be placed in the level that best describes their answer according to the descriptors in that level. Marks will be awarded towards the top or bottom of that level depending on how they have evidenced each of the descriptor bullet points.
- If the candidate's answer meets the requirements fully, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for work that is as good as can realistically be expected within that level.

AO1	Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement.
AO2	Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects.
AO3	Explore links and connections between texts.
AO4	Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written.

Section A – Unseen Poetry

Question number	Indicative content
1	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. It is not sufficient to summarise or paraphrase, nor is it sufficient simply to list literary devices. The writer's descriptive skills: - the opening of the poem presents the writer's need to use the picture of the 'stranger' to conceal the truth about the condition of the building where she lives: 'hangs where the plaster cracked / and the ribs of the house show'. The physical description of the house suggests a vulnerability in need of repair. This could also, perhaps, reflect the writer's need to disguise her own vulnerable, emotional state - it is suggested that the writer is struggling financially, and the only way to hide the fact that the house is in disrepair is by purchasing the picture of an unknown man: 'He's the only stranger I can afford' - although the writer conceals the truth about the 'stranger' from her visitors, she is honest with herself about the lack of connection she has with the man: 'Nothing to me' - the writer realises her visitors doubt the truth about the identity of the 'stranger': 'I know they know, / his hair's too light, the eyes too blue' - however, the writer manages to conceal the truth by presenting a detailed backstory for her 'dad', the 'stranger', such as how she recalls their 'fishing holidays' and how her 'dad' met her mother 'when she broke / down outside the Camden Palace' - the description of sentimental memories from her childhood, including how her 'dad' made a 'sherbert playhouse', helps to present an authentic, loving relationship between the writer and her 'dad', the 'stranger' - the writer refers to other members of her family and their relationship with her 'dad'. It is unclear for the reader if these details are also made up or if the combination of truths and lies contributes to the visitors' believing the writer's story about the 'stranger' in the picture - the writer ends the poem by describing missed opportunities in the life of her 'dad', the 'stranger', which help to focus her visitors' minds on what could have been, rather than the reality of the past: 'He never lived / to paint us all'. The writer's choice of language: - the emotive 'cracked' suggests the picture of the 'stranger' is needed to cover up severe damage to the house. This could also allude to possible 'cracks' in the writer's relationship with her real father - the writer refers to the 'stranger' as being the only one she can 'afford'. The reference to cost could, perhaps, suggest that concealing the truth comes at a price in monetary form. This could also, possibly, allude to a past relationship the writer has had, maybe with her real father, who she considers a 'stranger', which has come at an emotional cost to her - the writer portrays the act of hiding the truth about the 'stranger' as a game. Despite the visitors' initial doubting of the writer's connection with the man in the

portrait, the verbal phrase 'win them over' is indicative of the writer's satisfaction at successfully concealing her deceit

- the writer describes how her 'dad', the 'stranger', once went on a fishing trip and caught a trout. This could serve as a metaphor for how the writer has caught her visitors in her act of deception and has successfully hidden the truth about the 'stranger'
- the positive examples the writer uses to present an idealised view of her 'dad', the 'stranger', could be used as a way of hiding the stark reality of the writer's relationship with her real father. The writer lists the achievements of her 'dad', such as how he successfully taught her brother the harpsichord
- at the end of the poem, the verb 'whisper' is indicative of the writer's desire to continue to conceal the truth about the 'stranger', not just from her visitors but also from anyone else who might be able to hear the conversation. Alternatively, perhaps, she is just overwhelmed by the success of her pretence
- the verb 'lead' suggests that she wants to stay in control of the situation by leading her visitors into the living room, taking their focus away from the picture of the 'stranger', perhaps in fear that she is unable to keep up the pretence.

The writer's use of form and structure:

- the mysterious man identified in the title, *My Stranger*, acts as the subject of the first sentence of the poem, leading directly into the poem. The title makes it immediately clear that the writer has no connection with the man in the picture
- the writer is open about her deceit regarding the identity of the 'stranger' from the very start of the poem: 'Nothing to me, / but still I hang him in the hallway / and call him *Dad*'
- the focus of the poem then shifts to the effect of the writer's deception: 'Of course, visitors / have doubts'
- however, the writer persists in her concealing of the truth by listing made-up details of sentimental childhood memories, making her connection to the man in the picture believable. These untruths escalate as the poem progresses, starting with her 'dad' going on a fishing trip and ending with how he made her brother a world-renowned musician
- the two pieces of dialogue come at the end of the poem. The visitors express how sorry they are for the writer as they sigh: 'What a terrible loss'. The writer, perhaps fearing that she will let the truth slip, replies with just one word: 'Yes'
- the poem is just one stanza. This could represent the writer's need to keep up the pretence by reeling out as much detail as she can conjure up about the man's life and not allow the visitors time to find holes in her depiction.

These examples are suggestions only. Accept any valid responses.

Level	Mark	AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–4	- The response is simple and the identification of language, form and structure used by the writer is minimal. - Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	5–8	- The response may be largely descriptive, with some comment on the language, form and structure used by the writer. - Some use of relevant examples to support the response.
Level 3	9–12	- The response shows an understanding of the range of language, form and structure used by the writer and links these to their effect on the reader. - Use of clearly relevant examples to support the response.
Level 4	13–16	- The response is focused and detailed, and the analysis of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader is sustained. - Use of fully relevant examples to support the response.
Level 5	17–20	- The response is a cohesive evaluation of the interrelationship of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader. - Discriminating use of relevant examples to support the response.

Section B – Anthology Poetry

Question number	Indicative content
2	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on comparison of the two poems. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. It is not sufficient to summarise or paraphrase, nor is it sufficient simply to list literary devices. <i>Half-past Two</i> (AO2) Responses may include: - the writer conveys a sense of sympathy for the child featured in the poem. The boy is presented as innocent and confused when left alone and must wait ‘beyond onceupona’ and ‘Out of reach of all the timefors’; the child does not understand time and is forgotten by the teacher - sympathy is felt for the child who is clearly scared of authority: ‘too scared at being wicked to remind her’. The repeated use of capitalisation in ‘Something Very Wrong’ suggests that the teacher has made the child believe that it must have been serious, but the child is unaware of what he has actually done. This adds humour and evokes more sympathy for the child - parentheses, ‘(I forget what it was)’, provide the reader with additional information, the background of the situation and an adult viewpoint - compound words provide an innocent view of time in childhood: ‘Gettinguptime, timeyouwereofftime’ - the clock is personified to emphasise the child’s young age, and his vivid imagination grows when left alone: ‘the little eyes’, ‘two long legs for walking’. Sympathy is felt for the child in isolation, with only his thoughts to occupy him - repetition of ‘Into the’ to begin each line of the eighth stanza takes the child further and further into escapism - strong images help to convey sympathy for the child, as his experiences, alone in the ‘tick-less’ silence, are enhanced by the other senses: ‘smell of old chrysanthemums’ and the oxymoron ‘silent noise’ - the dialogue in italics emphasises how the child was forgotten: ‘<i>My goodness, she said</i>’. The teacher shows some sympathy for the child’s being left alone and then quickly ‘slotted him back into schooltime’ - the child never forgot ‘not knowing time’, suggestive of the lasting impact of the experience on the child. However, it is described as an escape, so it is not a wholly unpleasant experience: ‘He escaped into the clockless land for ever’ - the reader is left feeling sympathy for the child at the end of the poem. In contrast, very little sympathy is felt for the teacher, although her alarm when she realises that she has forgotten about the child could, arguably, evoke some sympathy for her.

Poem at Thirty-Nine

(AO2) Responses may include:

- the poem is about Walker's memories of her relationship with her father and his influence on her. The poem is autobiographical, and the title refers to Walker's age when she wrote it. The writer not only conveys a sense of sympathy for herself, but some is also felt for her father
- the opening statement conveys sympathy for Walker as she expresses sadness about the death of her father. This is repeated and exclaimed later in the poem: 'How I miss my father!'
- Walker feels that her relationship with her father was not as close as she would have liked. She regrets that her father was 'so tired / when I was / born'
- the poet thinks about the life skills her father taught her. She fondly remembers how he taught her the skill of 'Writing deposit slips and checks'. The poet demonstrates that she is now like her father, being careful with money: 'I learned to see / bits of paper / as a way / to escape the life he knew'. Some sympathy is felt for Walker's father as it is suggested that he once struggled financially
- Walker values her father's memory; he taught her the importance of 'telling the truth'. She has learned to be honest and indicates that her father would sometimes beat her for truths that must have 'grieved' him: 'that telling the truth / did not always mean / a beating'. This suggests that her relationship with her father was not always positive and that she and her father had disagreements, which helps to evoke sympathy
- the poet seeks approval from her father and thinks that he would be proud of her. Sympathy is felt for Walker because there is a sense that she wants her father to have been able to see her achievements in life: 'He would have grown / to admire / the woman I've become'. A sense of sympathy is also evoked for Walker's father's not being alive to see her success
- the use of 'I' and free verse matches the personal and nostalgic reflections, demonstrating the poet's love for her father, whilst revealing the strong, caring woman that she has become, even cooking like him, symbolising their shared attitude to life
- the poem is divided into two sections: past and present.

Both poems

Both poems have particular merits and features and therefore there are a number of points of comparison which students will make. Examiners might consider the following areas of comparison where applicable: treatment of subject matter and theme, tone, voice, attitude, character, diction, imagery including figurative language, poetic form/structure including rhythm, line length, enjambement.

All points of comparison should be developed and supported by close reference and evaluation of specific examples.

(AO3) Responses may include:

- both poems convey a sense of sympathy for the characters featured. Both are told by adults looking back. One poem tells of a lasting childhood memory; the other poem is about a daughter reflecting on her relationship with her father
- both poems use first person and third person. However, in *Half-past Two*, there is only one example of first person, which is in parenthesis. The use of the third person for the persona of the poem is what serves to highlight the isolation of the child, lost in time, which helps to evoke sympathy for his situation. The teacher is also in third person. The repeated use of first person and third person in *Poem at Thirty-Nine* helps to convey the close nature of the father-daughter relationship, which then helps to build a sense of sympathy for the loss of the writer's father
- in *Half-past Two* the writer includes dialogue, whereas in *Poem at Thirty-Nine* Walker only remembers what her father 'must have said', suggesting that the memories of her father are beginning to fade
- *Poem at Thirty-Nine* shifts between recollecting memories and the speaker's present-day life, whereas *Half-past Two* focuses purely on one situation experienced as a child.

These examples are suggestions only. Accept any valid responses.

Level	Mark	AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks) AO3 Explore links and connections between texts. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• The response is simple and the identification of language, form and structure used by the writer is minimal. • There is little or no comparison of the two poems. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• The response may be largely descriptive, with some comment on the language, form and structure used by the writer. • There are some underdeveloped comparisons and contrasts presented, with obvious similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Some use of relevant examples to support the response. NB: the mark awarded cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2 if only ONE poem has been considered.
Level 3	13–18	• The response shows an understanding of the range of language, form and structure used by the writer and links these to their effect on the reader. • The response compares and contrasts a range of points and considers some similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Use of clearly relevant examples to support the response.
Level 4	19–24	• The response is focused and detailed, and the analysis of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader is sustained. • The response compares and contrasts the poems effectively, considering a wide range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Use of fully relevant examples to support the response.
Level 5	25–30	• The response is a cohesive evaluation of the interrelationship of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader. • The response compares and contrasts the poems perceptively with a varied and comprehensive range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Discriminating use of relevant examples to support the response.

Question number	Indicative content
3	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on comparison of the two poems. Indicative content is offered for <i>My Last Duchess</i> but because candidates are asked to choose any other appropriate poem from the selection, it is not always possible to indicate content for the second except in generic ways. <i>My Last Duchess</i> (AO2) Responses may include: - the Duke's dramatic monologue reveals his unhappy memories about his relationship with his last Duchess. The reader is aware of the Duke's personal perspective, as he talks about and remembers her, and the reader has to see through the bias of the speaker's giving just one side of the story. He is speaking to the emissary of a Count, whose daughter is his next proposed bride - the Duke's relationship with his Duchess is revealed as having been difficult: 'Sir, 'twas not / Her husband's presence only, called that spot / Of joy into the Duchess' cheek' - he demonstrates his pride and arrogance when suggesting his Duchess was ungrateful and feels that: 'My gift of a nine-hundred-years-old name' should not be ranked with 'anybody's gift' - the Duke demonstrates how he felt jealous of his wife's interactions with other men: 'she liked whate'er / She looked on, and her looks went everywhere'. The Duchess enjoyed the attention of others and accepted their compliments: she was 'too soon made glad'. It is suggested that he believes that the Duchess did not show him the special admiration and respect he felt he deserved - the Duke's relationship with his Duchess has sinister overtones when it is implied that he was responsible for her demise: 'I gave commands; / Then all smiles stopped together. There she stands / As if alive'. The Duke does not explicitly mention the death of the Duchess but uses abrupt euphemisms - from the Duke's account, the memories demonstrate a relationship with an unequal balance of power, and the story is told by the survivor, the victor, underlined by the description of the statue that shows the god, Neptune, 'Taming a sea-horse' - the opening and closing lines also show that the Duchess is seen as a possession, another work of art, on a level with the statue - the poem is structured in rhyming couplets and is in iambic pentameter. The use of caesura breaks the flow of a number of lines, making the poem more fragmented and adding to the evasive tone of the narration, indicative of the Duke's unhappy memories - some candidates may consider the unhappy memories of the Duchess. <i>My Last Duchess</i> and one other poem Both poems have particular merits and features and therefore there are a number of points of comparison which students will make. Examiners might consider the following areas of comparison where applicable: treatment of subject matter

	and theme, tone, voice, attitude, character, diction, imagery including figurative language, poetic form/structure including rhythm, line length, enjambement. All points of comparison should be developed and supported by close reference and evaluation of specific examples. (AO3) Responses may include: • the poem chosen must be one in which unhappy memories are a significant theme, such as <i>Hide and Seek</i>, <i>La Belle Dame sans Merci</i>, <i>War Photographer</i>, <i>Half-caste</i> or any other appropriate poem from the collection • the similarities and differences of subject matter in each poem will be considered • comparative links made between techniques, such as specific comparisons made in relation to language, and supporting these points with relevant evidence from the two poems, will be evident • comparisons and comments will be made on the use of form and structure • comparisons of how the two poems affect the reader may be considered. These examples are suggestions only. Accept any valid responses.
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Level 2	7–12	• The response may be largely descriptive, with some comment on the language, form and structure used by the writer. • There are some underdeveloped comparisons and contrasts presented, with obvious similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Some use of relevant examples to support the response. NB: the mark awarded cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2 if only ONE poem has been considered.
Level 3	13–18	• The response shows an understanding of the range of language, form and structure used by the writer and links these to their effect on the reader. • The response compares and contrasts a range of points and considers some similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Use of clearly relevant examples to support the response.
Level 4	19–24	• The response is focused and detailed, and the analysis of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader is sustained. • The response compares and contrasts the poems effectively, considering a wide range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Use of fully relevant examples to support the response.
Level 5	25–30	• The response is a cohesive evaluation of the interrelationship of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader. • The response compares and contrasts the poems perceptively with a varied and comprehensive range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Discriminating use of relevant examples to support the response.

Section C – Modern Prose

Question number	Indicative content
4 <i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • innocence is a prominent theme throughout the novel. This is evident from the title, as a mockingbird is a significant symbol of innocence. Many characters demonstrate different types of innocence • like a mockingbird, Tom Robinson is an innocent who is unprepared for the evil he encounters, and, as a result, he is destroyed. His innocent generosity in helping Mayella and pitying her is exploited and twisted when she falsely accuses him of rape. He is killed as he tries to escape from prison • Boo Radley is an innocent – a shy loner; he is kept at home by his brother and is a neighbour of the Finch family • the key question behind the novel about the innate moral nature of humanity is reflected in the dramatisation of the transition of Scout and Jem from childhood innocence to a more adult perspective • Scout's narrative begins with clear demonstrations of her innocence, childish superstitions and misunderstandings, through comments about Miss Caroline's teaching methods, the Dewey Decimal System, her believing that Boo Radley is a 'malevolent phantom' and her calling Jem's snowman an 'Absolute Morphodite' • however, with the help of her father, Atticus, Scout comes to understand some of Maycomb's flaws, such as how society is segregated and unjust. Atticus tells Scout that she should try to climb into another's skin 'and walk around in it' in order to understand the person • Jem begins to lose his childhood innocence when he no longer wishes to play games with Scout and when he starts to correct her behaviour: 'he was now positively allergic to my presence when in public' • Jem develops some maturity following Tom Robinson's trial, and he realises Maycomb's society is not as perfect as he has previously believed. Jem also gains a deeper understanding of human nature when, after destroying Mrs Dubose's camellias, he must read to her for a set period every day as his punishment. After her death, Atticus tells him that she has been in severe pain and battling a morphine addiction: 'she died beholden to nothing and nobody. She was the bravest person' • as the novel progresses, the children's changing attitude to Boo is an important measurement of their growth from innocence to a more mature understanding. Boo has suffered a cruel childhood, but, in spite of this, in saving Jem and Scout from Bob Ewell, he is the ultimate symbol of good. By protecting Boo, Atticus and Heck Tate allow him to maintain his innocence as a mockingbird character.

	(AO4) • the title of the novel is symbolic; a mockingbird is a type of small, innocent bird with a beautiful song, commonly found in North America • Scout says that public exposure of Boo would be 'like shootin' a mockingbird'; this, and the treatment of Tom Robinson, contributes to Scout's learning about the life, injustice and racism of 1930s America • the realisation that society is divided along racial grounds is at the heart of the lessons that Jem and Scout have to learn. When Mrs Dubose makes Jem angry, by insulting Atticus for defending a black man, his violent response and Atticus' subsequent lesson in empathy are instrumental in helping Jem widen his perspective • Harper Lee portrays growing up through the loss of innocence and gaining an understanding of, and empathy for, another person's point of view. Lee's childhood mirrors Scout's: both did not conform to gender stereotypes, and both of their fathers were lawyers.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
5 <i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Jeremy (Jem) Atticus Finch is Scout's older brother by four years and ages from 10 to nearly 13 during the novel. Jem is presented as a character who begins to mature, through his relationship with Scout and Dill, and as a result of the trial. Jem is aware of events surrounding him and he explains things to Scout • Jem is immediately put at the centre of the narrative when we learn about his broken arm and Scout tells the story of how this happened. Jem identifies with Tom Robinson because Jem's injury following Bob Ewell's attack leaves 'His left arm ... somewhat shorter than the right', just like Tom Robinson's. Tom Robinson sustained his injury on the cotton gin at approximately the same age. Ironically, Bob Ewell was responsible both for breaking Jem's arm and for Tom's conviction and death • Jem is presented as imaginative and inventive. He creates a description of Boo Radley and fascinates Dill with his tale about 'Hot Steam'. He improvises particularly well when he builds a snowman largely out of soil, prompting Atticus to say: 'I'll never worry about what'll become of you, son, you'll always have an idea' • Jem is presented as protective of his father. When Mrs Dubose criticises Atticus, Jem beheads her camellias in his anger. Atticus makes Jem read to Mrs Dubose every day to make amends • Jem learns the true meaning of bravery. At the beginning of the novel, Scout says that he 'never declined a dare' and was brave to touch the Radley house. As events unfold, he learns what courage is when he observes his father shoot the rabid dog, Tim Johnson, and when he is told about Mrs Dubose fighting her morphine addiction • Jem's relationship with Scout is central to the novel. As siblings, they play and fight each other. He is presented as protective of her, as in the flight from the Radley yard and during Bob Ewell's assault towards the end of the novel. However, he can also be patronising and Scout often finds him irritating with his 'maddening superiority' • Jem is sensible and has strong principles. When he discovers that Dill has run away from home, Jem tells Atticus about it. Jem advises Dill to let his mother know where he is because he believes it is the right thing to do • Jem wants to become a lawyer when he grows up. He has great admiration and respect for his father and wants to avoid upsetting Atticus. However, he refuses to go home when Atticus tells him to when they are faced by the lynch mob. Jem is proud of Scout when

	she confronts the mob at the gaol • Jem is presented as idealistic and struggles to understand how Tom's guilty verdict can be justice • Jem grows from a boy, who drags his sister along as a co-conspirator, to a young gentleman, who protects Scout and tries to help her understand the implications of the events around her. (AO4) • Jem is presented as horrified by the trial verdict, and it shatters his belief in the fairness of Maycomb people and even the law itself. When Scout tells him about Miss Gates' hypocrisy and prejudice, he is furious • the realisation that society is divided along racial grounds is at the heart of the lessons that Jem and Scout have to learn. When Mrs Dubose makes Jem angry, by insulting Atticus for defending a black man, his violent response and Atticus' subsequent lesson in empathy are instrumental in helping Jem widen his perspective • the white population of Maycomb is also divided between the comfortably off and the poor. Aunt Alexandra is particularly concerned that Jem should behave as befits his 'gentle breeding' • racial segregation and the Jim Crow Laws provide a context for many events of the novel. Tom Robinson's trial may well have been informed by the Scottsboro trials of 1931.
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Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
6 <i>Of Mice and Men</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Candy is an important character in the novel even though his job is just that of the ‘old swamper’, which largely involves sweeping and cleaning the bunk house. He is described as ‘a tall, stoop-shouldered old man’. He is dressed in the denim clothing that is typically worn by the workers • he is the first person at the ranch to greet George and Lennie on their arrival. Candy has lost his right hand in a farming accident and points out their bunks with his ‘stick-like wrist’ • Candy is important because he represents the isolation felt by some on the ranch. His only friend is an old sheepdog that has been with him since the dog was a pup. Candy speaks proudly of the dog’s prowess in younger days: ‘he was the best damn sheepdog I ever seen’. When Carlson pushes for the dog to be shot, Candy protests: ‘Well – hell! I had him so long’. Eventually, following Slim’s approval, Carlson leads the dog outside to shoot him in the back of the head. When the shot rings out, Candy turns miserably to face the wall • the relationship between Candy and his dog is important because it mirrors that of George and Lennie. Candy tells George that he should have shot his dog himself, foreshadowing George’s decision to end Lennie’s life himself at the end of the novel • Candy becomes part of the dream, and he is important because it is his compensation money that appears to put the dream within their reach. After overhearing George and Lennie talking about the dream of owning their own place, Candy offers his money towards the ‘little place’ that George describes. He convinces them by offering to work and pledges: ‘I’d make a will an’ leave my share to you guys’ • weak characters, such as Candy, are at the bottom of the hierarchy on the ranch. However, Candy is important because he shows that even weak people can be provoked into standing up for themselves. When Curley’s wife joins Candy, Lennie and Crooks in Crooks’ room on the evening when the other men go into town, she says ‘They left all the weak ones here’, ironically not realising that she is including herself in this statement. She refers to Candy as ‘a lousy ol’ sheep’. Candy stands up to her: ‘You got no call foolin’ aroun’ with other guys, causin’ trouble’ • it is Candy who discovers the body of Curley’s wife in the barn and raises the alarm with George. Candy blames Curley’s wife for the trouble she has caused, reacting angrily to her dead body: ‘You done it, di’n’t you? ... Ever’body knowed you’d mess things up’ • Candy holds out a brief hope that perhaps he and George will be able to fulfil the dream themselves. However, George admits that he ‘knowed we’d never do her’, and, when George does not answer Candy’s asking whether it is ‘all off’, Candy knows that their dream is over. This represents how the American Dream was often unachievable.

(AO4)

- because of his disability and age, Candy is fortunate to have a job. He is aware that he will soon be 'canned' and put 'on the county'
- it was unusual, during the Great Depression, for someone like Candy to have savings. He has wages due to him and 250 dollars compensation money, which is important in the novel because he can offer 'three hundred an' fifty bucks' to be a part of George's and Lennie's dream
- Candy faces a bleak future of homelessness and poverty as the novel ends. There was very little social care during the 1930s
- Candy, like most other workers on the ranch, and very much typical of the time, is racially prejudiced. He tells George about the events one Christmas when Crooks was allowed in the bunk house. Candy 'paused in relish of the memory' of how Crooks was beaten by another ranch worker, Smitty.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
7 <i>Of Mice and Men</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • throughout the novel, numerous characters share their hope to have a better and fairer life. The American Dream, the idea that every American has the opportunity for a full and rich life, is an aspiration for many of the characters but, for typical ranch hands, often the hope they have is just a fantasy • George's and Lennie's dream is central to the novel, and it offers them hope of better things to come. The shifting nature of work as itinerant ranch hands means George and Lennie have no stability, home, possessions or families. They hope, eventually, to be able to 'live off the fatta the lan' , and their hope for the future helps them through their most difficult and lonely times • Lennie dreams of tending the rabbits, and George is also mesmerised by the image he creates when he tells Lennie about the 'big vegetable patch and a rabbit hutch and chickens' that they will have. However, in reality, there is little hope of their achieving this, and even that chance is removed when Lennie accidentally kills Curley's wife • Candy hopes to have enough savings to live on during his retirement. When Candy meets George and Lennie, their dream of living in their own place becomes more of a possibility. Candy offers the men his savings to buy 'a little place' that George knows about. Candy is excited about their prospects and plans for the future by 'figurin' ' when others have gone to the 'cat house'. Candy's hope ends when Curley's wife is killed by Lennie. Candy knows that without Lennie, George will not continue with the dream • Crooks momentarily hopes that he can live with George, Lennie and Candy. He offers to help them: 'If you ... guys would want a hand to work for nothing – just his keep, why I'd come an' lend a hand'. When Curley's wife arrives, she soon reduces him 'into himself' as he 'seemed to grow smaller'. Crooks, as a black man, knows his place in that society and any hope he has quickly evaporates • Curley's wife had hoped to be in the movies. She tells Lennie the story of when a man promised to write to her with an offer. Curley's wife naively believes that her mother stole this letter and, in retaliation, marries Curley. She confesses that she does 'not like Curley', even though they have only been married a fortnight. Curley's wife's hope for the future has already been extinguished when she marries Curley • as the son of the boss, Curley already has a comfortable life, but he hopes to become a professional boxer. The hope Curley has for this future is probably ruined when Lennie crushes his hand. Curley's hope for revenge on Lennie is thwarted at the time by Slim, and, later, when Lennie escapes Curley's posse. (AO4) • the title of the novel is taken from the poem <i>To a Mouse, on Turning Her Up in Her Nest With the Plough, November, 1785</i> written by the Scottish poet,

	Robert (Robbie) Burns. The poem tells the story of a mouse running away from the approaching farmer's scythe when her nest is destroyed. The lines: <i>The best laid schemes o' mice an' men / Gang aft a-gley</i> (astray) are reflected in the experiences of some of the characters in the novel • the American Dream is a term coined by James Truslow Adams in 1931. Adams stated that 'life should be better and richer and fuller for everyone, with opportunity for each according to ability or achievement'. The concept of the American Dream is central to the American national ethos and includes democracy, rights, liberty and equality • the economic hardships experienced during the Great Depression left little opportunity for future plans to be realised. Characters have their hopes for the future, but none of their hopes materialise • the ranch is representative of American society, with its own hierarchy. Racism and sexism were the norm during the time the novel is set.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
8 The Whale Rider	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Rawiri is Porourangi's younger brother and Kahu's uncle. Rawiri's caring nature is apparent through his relationship with his family and the respect he shows to his culture and traditions • Rawiri is supportive of his brother and, as narrator, he portrays Porourangi in a positive way. Porourangi tells Nanny (Nani) Flowers that Rehua, his wife and Kahu's mother, wants Kahu's birth cord buried in the <i>marae</i>. Rawiri is appointed one of Kahu's guardians by Nanny and he helps her put Kahu's afterbirth in 'the earth on the <i>marae</i>', the Maori tribe's sacred meeting area, despite Koro's disapproval. Although Rawiri respects Koro as the chief of Whangara, he is able to see how the misogyny of the recent Maori traditions results in Koro's scorning of Kahu • when Rehua dies, Rawiri is sympathetic to his brother and he forms a close bond with his niece, Kahu. As Kahu grows up, he takes her out, such as to the cinema and sheep-shearing events, where she becomes a mascot for him and the others during the time she spends in Whangara • Rawiri travels to Australia and later to Papua New Guinea, where his caring nature is apparent when he is involved in helping a native plantation worker who has been in an accident. It is at this time that he sees a vision of a whale in the clouds and realises that he must return home • Rawiri's care for Kahu is evident when he moves back to Whangara to be close to her. He gets a 'lump in his throat' when he sees Kahu returning from school, and Rawiri describes Kahu, now seven, as a 'long legged beauty with a sparkle and infectious giggle'. He admits to himself that he 'hadn't realised how much' he has missed her • Rawiri goes with his brother, Porourangi, and Nanny to Kahu's break-up ceremony at school. The care Rawiri has for his niece is apparent. Following Kahu's recitation of the Koro's <i>Whakapapa</i>, Rawiri says his 'heart was aching for her' because of Koro's absence, but at the end he feels so proud of her and leaps to his feet 'to do a haka of support for her' • Rawiri, together with Nanny Flowers, witnesses Kahu diving and retrieving the stone that Koro threw into the ocean to set the boys a test. They agree to keep this a secret from Koro, who still rejects Kahu. Rawiri wants to protect Kahu • when the herd of whales beaches itself, Rawiri telephones Porourangi and Koro, who are away on the South Island. Rawiri tries to protect Kahu by asking Nanny not to let Kahu see the news. The men travel to the beach, and they work as a team trying to save the sacred bull whale. Later, when Rawiri discovers that Kahu knows what has happened, he comforts her • at the end of the novel, Rawiri's care for Kahu is evident when he risks his life to save her. When Kahu swims out to climb on to the bull whale, Rawiri tries to stop her, but is left in despair when a wave sweeps him away from her.

(AO4)

- as narrator, Rawiri is sympathetic to the female Kahu and comments 'it was Kahu's intervention which perhaps saved us all', demonstrating Kahu's value, even though female, to Maori society
- Rawiri's experiences of travelling to Australia and Papua New Guinea serve as a way to explore Maori identity outside New Zealand. Rawiri's experiences abroad also provide contrasts between the modern Westernised world and his traditional Maori identity
- during Rawiri's travels, he learns what it is like to be different and the implicit racism that exists. Jeff's mother considers Rawiri 'too dark' and likens him to 'dogs and strays'
- Maori customs and traditions are central to the novel. The burying of Kahu's afterbirth is one custom that creates tension between Koro and Nanny but forges a bond between Rawiri, Porourangi and Kahu.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
9 The Whale Rider	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • leadership is significant in the novel. Candidates may consider Koro Apirana's leadership of the Maori tribe; that of the whale rider, Kahutia Te Rangi or Paikea, and that of the bull whale. Although the leadership of the tribe has been mainly traditionally male, candidates may also consider Nanny (Nani) Flowers' indirect leadership, through Koro, Kahu's leadership when leading the whales to safety and Nanny's powerful female ancestor, Muriwai • Koro Apirana is chief of the tribe and Kahu's great-grandfather. He is a successful tribal leader because he has knowledge of the fishing grounds and has a close affinity with the whales; he is a guardian of 'sacred knowledge' and displays genuine wisdom: 'It is a reminder of the oneness which the world once had' • Koro is desperate for a male heir to lead the tribe in the future, which is significant because his stubborn ways and traditional views make him reject Kahu. Much of the novel centres on Kahu's determination to prove herself, as a worthy leader, to her great-grandfather • when his grandson, Porourangi, has only daughters, Koro is disappointed, and he is angry when his wife, Nanny, and Porourangi name Kahu after the whale rider, Kahutia Te Rangi. Koro is worried about the future of the tribe and is desperate to teach the boys of the tribe Maori culture, traditions and language • Nanny demonstrates a veiled form of leadership as she makes decisions and influences Koro. She is descended from a line of strong Maori women. Her real name is Putiputi, which means 'flowers'. She allows Porourangi to name his daughter after the whale rider and makes the arrangements to bury Kahu's afterbirth. Her leadership is significant in the novel because she is able to influence her husband into seeing the errors of his ways. As a result, he eventually accepts Kahu as a worthy female leader • the legend of Kahutia Te Rangi (Paikea) is significant because it is central to the novel. The original whale rider is one of the Ancients. He is the original founder of Whangara and has led others to the island • in the legend, the bull whale swam with Kahutia Te Rangi and the whale remains obsessed with his memories. He returns to New Zealand to make his 'last journey'. The bull whale leads the pod to the island and to their possible death. When he deliberately beaches himself at Whangara, he is saved by Kahu, who persuades him to swim back to sea • Kahu demonstrates leadership qualities when she retrieves the stone from the bottom of the seabed, something that the boys in the tribe could not do. Kahu is a 'throwback', someone demonstrating characteristics of their ancestors of a previous age. She is able to communicate with the whales and when she climbs on the bull whale's back, she is able to lead it and the other whales to safety • ultimately, Koro's leadership skills are significant because he is able to accept that he is wrong and change his view of Kahu. At the end of the novel, when he

goes to Kahu's bedside at the hospital, he asks 'the Gods to forgive him'. When Kahu regains consciousness, he tells her that he loves her. Kahu is overjoyed: 'The old man cradled Kahu in his arms, partly because of emotion and partly because he didn't want those big ears out there to hear their big chief crying'.

(AO4)

- Paikea (Kahutia Te Rangi) is one of the Ancients, a group of Polynesians who were ancestors of the Maori and who settled in New Zealand, or Aotearoa as it was known, long before European settlers
- Witi Ihimaera published the novel in 1987 during a time of increased concerns about the environment
- through his novel, Ihimaera explores Maori culture, traditions and legends. When Koro learns that he has a great-granddaughter, he is disappointed and 'won't have anything to do with her'. He cannot 'reconcile his traditional beliefs about Maori leadership and rights with Kahu's birth'
- the legend of Paikea and Koro's desire and obsession for a patrilineal descendant determine Koro's treatment of Kahu and the reactions of his wife. Koro comes to understand that salvation can be embodied in female form and that his bloodline must disregard assumptions about male superiority.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
10 <i>The Joy Luck Club</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • there are a number of examples of characters trying to do the right thing in the novel. In particular, the mothers make decisions that they believe to be in the best interests of their daughters, but their daughters do not always fully appreciate their mothers' good intentions • Suyuan Woo acted in, what she believed to be, the best interests of her twins when she abandoned them in China in the hope that they would be rescued. Suyuan, weak with dysentery, left her daughters with everything that she had • in America, Suyuan works extra hours to pay for Jing-mei's piano lessons. She wants her daughter to believe that she can achieve anything and live a fulfilled life. Jing-mei later admits how she misunderstood her mother's good intentions • An-mei Hsu talks of how her mother did what she thought was the right thing when her mother cut off her own flesh to make a medicinal broth for An-mei's dying grandmother, Popo, despite having been disowned by her. An-mei's mother later killed herself to protect her daughter. An-mei would have been willing to sacrifice her own life or possessions without any hesitation if it would save her son, Bing • the relationship between An-mei and her daughter, Rose Hsu Jordan, is often fraught with misunderstandings and differences of opinion. Rose is in an unhappy marriage to Ted, and her mother encourages her to speak up for herself and to be assertive. In doing so, An-mei believes that she is doing the right thing; she is determined that her daughter should not experience a life such as hers • Lindo, Waverly Jong's mother, acts in what she believes to be her youngest daughter's best interests by teaching her to be strong and to hide her thoughts with 'invisible strength'. Lindo makes sacrifices to support Waverly to become a champion chess player and, later, a successful attorney. Waverly believes that her mother is too critical and controlling. It is not until later, when Waverly becomes a mother herself, that she appreciates her mother's actions and the sacrifices she has made in her life for her • Ying-ying St. Clair lives in constant fear and anxiety and believes she is powerless. Fearing that her daughter, Lena, will repeat the errors of her own life, Ying-ying does the right thing by telling her daughter her story in order to help her daughter avoid making the same mistakes. Lena is unhappily married to Harold Livotny. Lena's marriage is not equal and she is passive in her relationship with him. Ying-ying urges her daughter to take more control in her life and live up to their zodiac symbol of the Tiger • although Jing-mei is reluctant to travel to China to meet her half-sisters, she realises how her mother dreamt of being reunited with her lost daughters. She does the right thing by making the trip there with her father, Canning

Woo. Jing-mei's experience in China helps her to appreciate her Chinese identity, deepening her connection with her mother: 'And now I also see what part of me is Chinese. It is so obvious. It is my family. It is in our blood. After all these years, I can finally be let go'.

(AO4)

- the mothers' stories convey their experiences and how they fled China to start new lives in America during and after the Second World War, when immigration restrictions were eased
- the American Dream is a phrase coined by James Truslow Adams and is rooted in the Declaration of Independence: it is the ideal that every citizen of the United States should have equal opportunities to achieve success and prosperity through hard work, determination and initiative
- storytelling and the use of parables is a part of Chinese culture. The mothers, through their stories, imagine a future in America where their daughters will have better lives and will be judged by their personal abilities and not valued because of their husbands
- Suyuan Woo's story in *The Joy Luck Club* very much mirrors the story of Amy Tan's mother, who was also forced to make difficult decisions in the best interests of her daughters. Tan learned that her mother, prior to moving to America, had been married to an abusive partner and had left behind three daughters. In 1987, Tan travelled with her mother back to China, where her mother was reunited with her daughters.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
11 <i>The Joy Luck Club</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - Jing-mei Woo is the main narrator in the novel and her narratives serve as a bridge between the two generations: the mothers and daughters. She speaks for both herself and her deceased mother, Suyuan. The novel tracks Jing-mei's journey of discovery, during which she changes by learning not just about herself, but also coming to understand her mother's true nature - as a child, Jing-mei is embarrassed by her mother and Chinese heritage. She scorns the strange clothes that all the mothers wear to the Joy Luck Club, describing them as 'funny Chinese dresses with stiff stand-up collars and blooming branches of embroidered silk sewn over their breasts'. She also feels that the Joy Luck Club is a 'shameful Chinese custom, like the secret gathering of the Ku Klux Klan or the tom-tom dances of TV Indians preparing for war' - Suyuan has high expectations of her daughter, which creates tension between them. Suyuan makes Jing-mei play the piano in the hope that she will be a child prodigy. She tells her daughter that she can be anything she wants. Earlier, Suyuan wants her to compete with the success of Waverly Jong, and eventually to become a famous pianist, just like the television celebrity, Ginny Tiu. Jing-mei mistakes her mother's high expectations and criticism of her for a lack of affection. It is not until later in the novel that Jing-mei comes to realise that her mother's behaviour was actually indicative of her love for her - despite the tension between mother and daughter, they go shopping together. Jing-mei helps her mother buy crabs for the New Year celebrations. Afterwards, when preparing the meal, the mother is frustrated by the noisy neighbours and their cat, which Jing-mei later suspects her mother of killing - at the New Year's dinner, Jing-mei serves herself inferior quality crab. Waverly belittles Jing-mei, and Suyuan scolds her daughter for her failure, which she considers to be indicative of Jing-mei's lack of self-respect. Suyuan then gives her daughter the gift of a jade pendant, her 'life's importance', and she tells Jing-mei 'This is young jade. It is a very light color now, but if you wear it every day it will become more green'. Suyuan understands that her daughter, just like the pendant, will mature over time. At first, Jing-mei dislikes the pendant and sees it as a cultural symbol, but, after her mother's death, she changes and values it as a symbol of love. The pendant is also a symbol of understanding as Jing-mei learns to appreciate her mother's words of wisdom - Jing-mei admits that she feels she has not really known her mother. Suyuan dies in San Francisco in the 1980s and Jing-mei's father asks her to take her mother's seat at the Joy Luck Club. Although Jing-mei is reluctant, she does take her mother's place - Jing-mei cares for her father, fulfilling her mother's role in the family. She cooks dinner for him, as he has not been eating well since his wife's death.

When Jing-mei hears the neighbours upstairs, she begins to understand why her mother complained about them. The neighbour's cat appears at the window and Jing-mei realises that her mother did not harm it

- Suyuan's friends at the Joy Luck Club ask Jing-mei to go to China to meet her half-sisters. Ying-ying advises Jing-mei to tell them about their mother: 'The mother they did not know, they must now know'. Jing-mei confesses that she does not know what to tell her half-sisters, which prompts the other mothers to voice Suyuan's virtues and share their stories. This helps to change Jing-mei's understanding of her mother
- Jing-mei gains further understanding of who her mother was in the past when she travels to Shanghai to meet her half-sisters, whose father was Suyuan's first husband, Wang Fuchi. Suyuan had been forced to abandon her twin daughters when fleeing the Japanese. The three sisters all look like Suyuan. Jing-mei's experience in China helps her to appreciate her Chinese identity, deepening her connection with her mother: 'And now I also see what part of me is Chinese. It is so obvious. It is my family. It is in our blood. After all these years, I can finally be let go'.

(AO4)

- Amy Tan was inspired to write *The Joy Luck Club* after listening to her own mother's stories about her life in China; the novel is set in San Francisco in the 1980s and the stories span a range of decades from the 1920s. Jing-mei's story mirrors Amy Tan's own experiences
- in the Chinese tradition, Suyuan expects Jing-mei to obey her elders and learn by obedience, observation and imitation
- during and after the Second World War, immigration restrictions were eased as the United States allied with China against Japanese expansion. Jing-mei's life is influenced by her exposure to American culture and her mother's Chinese heritage
- the Chinese culture is a high-context culture: the bonds among people are very strong, within the family unit, particularly to Suyuan. The ways of behaving are important and not observing cultural traditions brings shame on the entire family. This contrasts with the low-context culture of America, epitomised through Jing-mei: change is rapid and easy, and bonds between people are looser.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
12 <i>Things Fall Apart</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • candidates are free to choose any character they respect in the novel. They are likely to choose Obierika, Chielo, Nwoye, Ikemefuna or even Okonkwo, but any choice is valid. Responses should be rewarded based on the arguments presented • Obierika could be deemed worthy of respect. He is Okonkwo's closest friend, providing him with advice and acting as a voice of reason. Obierika decides not to take part in Ikemefuna's murder, claiming that he has 'something better to do'. After Okonkwo kills Ikemefuna, he goes to see Obierika. Obierika warns Okonkwo that his actions will have upset the Earth goddess, who will seek her revenge. However, Obierika, being a good friend, listens to Okonkwo and that night Okonkwo is finally able to sleep • candidates might also consider how Obierika is open-minded and receptive to new ideas: 'Who knows what may happen tomorrow?' Unlike Okonkwo, Obierika rejects the use of violence and will not consider using force against the colonisers • candidates might choose Chielo as the character they respect. Chielo is the Priestess of Agbala, who is highly respected in Umuofia. She assists in making important decisions and dedicates herself to the Oracle of Agbala, the Oracle of the Hills and the Caves • despite being a woman in a male-dominated society, Chielo could be deemed respectable. Her word is not questioned when she is possessed by the Oracle, Agbala. Chielo takes Ezimna to Agbala's cave, after which it appears Ezimna's health worries disappear • Nwoye could be a character candidates deem worthy of respect. He is presented as a gentle and sensitive character who has to endure regular beatings from his father • when Nwoye realises that his father has murdered Ikemefuna, he distances himself from him and other clansmen. Nwoye shows bravery when he breaks away from his father and Igbo (Ibo in the novel) traditions by becoming a Christian and changing his name to Isaac. Nwoye is captivated by the missionaries' songs and the 'poetry of the new religion' • it could be argued that Ikemefuna is a character worthy of respect in the novel. Ikemefuna helps the reader to see a softer side of Okonkwo, who is filled with grief and remorse over killing him. Ikemefuna is adored by Nwoye, and it is his death that motivates Nwoye to choose his own direction in life and distance himself from his father • candidates might choose Okonkwo as the character they respect. He demonstrates both physical and mental strengths throughout the novel. Motivated by his desire to be the opposite of his father, Okonkwo proves himself as a wrestling champion, and he becomes a successful warrior and wealthy farmer • Okonkwo's strength and position are rewarded when the elders select him to be Ikemefuna's guardian. It could be argued that Okonkwo's downfall, following

his striking the fatal blow in Ikemefuna's murder, is a direct result of his determination to maintain his good reputation and to prove himself as being the polar opposite of his father.

(AO4)

- Igbo rituals and ceremonies are important in all aspects of Obierika's life, such as the *isa-ifi* ceremony where a bride must pledge faithfulness to her future husband after a test of separation
- the Agbala Oracle, or Oracle of the Hills and the Caves, is based on the Awka Oracle that was destroyed by the British early in the 20th century
- Ekwefi knows that she could be cursed for disobeying Chielo by following her to the cave. It shows how seriously Chielo's role as priestess is taken by the people of Umuofia. Even Okonkwo shows respect for her and acknowledges her authority
- Nwoye challenges all that is important to his father. The novel is set in a patriarchal society, where fathers are often feared. The novel explores the importance of kinship, extended families and their roles and responsibilities
- Ikemefuna illustrates the ways Umuofian people settled disputes, as he is used as payment in a peace settlement. His fate is foreshadowed when he is introduced in the novel as an 'ill-fated boy'.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
13 <i>Things Fall Apart</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • marriage is significant in the novel as traditions, ceremonies and rituals are a central aspect of Igbo (Ibo in the novel) society • in Igbo culture, it is expected that wives will be subservient to their husbands. Okonkwo's wives obey him unconditionally. He provides for his three wives, making his wealth visible to others. His <i>obi</i> (hut) is behind a gate in the red wall, and his three wives each have their own hut behind it • when Obierika and Okonkwo discuss the death of an elder, they scorn the close relationship he had with his wife, especially when the death of the widow complicates the announcement of the elder's death and funeral arrangements. This is significant because it is believed that it is a sign of weakness for a man to be inseparable from, or publicly loving towards, his wife or wives • wives and their daughters are expected to prepare meals and do not eat until the husband begins his meal. This is significant in the novel because when Ojiubo, Okonkwo's third and youngest wife, has her hair braided rather than preparing her dish for his meal, Okonkwo violates the 'Week of Peace' by beating her for her failure • the number of children a wife has and how many of these are male are significant factors in determining her status. Nwoye's mother is never known by her own name. Ekwefi has lost nine children in infancy and her only surviving child is Ezinma. Despite only having a daughter, Ekwefi remains Okonkwo's favourite • it is traditional for Igbo society to negotiate a bride's price between her family and the groom's relatives. This is decided by passing sticks, representing numbers, back and forth until the price is agreed, such as when Obierika's daughter is to be married • marriage negotiations are an affair for the whole tribe, illustrated through the arrangements for Obierika's daughter's marriage where the husband-to-be presents palm oil to everyone in the bride's immediate family, her relatives and her extended group of kinsmen. For this ceremony, it is traditional for the bride's mother to prepare food for the whole village with the help of other women. Palm wine is traditionally drunk by the male relatives • it is significant that women have little or no power over their men and are subjected to violent assaults. The <i>egwugwu</i> hear the case of Uzowulu and Mgbafo. Uzowulu regularly beats his wife and, after a severe beating, her family must rescue her before he kills her. The <i>egwugwu</i> simply instruct him to appease the family with wine and tell him it is not brave to beat a woman. One elder cannot understand why the <i>egwugwu</i> must bother 'with such a trifle' • when Ezinma is living in Mbanta, a number of suitors ask for her hand in marriage, but Ezinma knows her father wants her to marry someone in Umuofia when they return from exile. Ezinma's loyalty to her father is evident when she encourages her half-sister, Obiageli, to do likewise.

(AO4)

- polygamy and patriarchy are accepted in this culture. Men would father numerous children to increase their status. Uchendu has 27 children who gather for the *isa-ifi* ceremony which determines whether a bride has been faithful to her future husband
- some women in Igbo society are relatively respected and important, such as the 'senior' wives and the women who paint the houses of the *egwugwu*; at Nwakibie's *obi*, when his first wife has not yet arrived, 'the others could not drink before her'
- in Igbo culture, the death of a woman who dies before her husband can be announced, but it is considered suspicious if the woman dies shortly after her husband. The wife must be buried before the death of her husband is announced
- daughters are sold to suitable suitors. The price is negotiated through discussion and the ritual of passing sticks, representing numbers, between the bride's family and the groom's relatives.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
14 <i>Klara and the Sun</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Josie's mother, Chrissie, referred to by Klara as 'the Mother', is presented as a character who wants the best for her daughter • early in the novel, the Mother is presented as protective of her daughter. When Josie and her mother first visit the Artificial Friends (AF) store, Klara describes how the Mother 'was standing right behind Josie' and how she rests her hand on Josie's shoulder • when deciding whether to purchase Klara for Josie, the Mother is presented as demanding. She interrogates Klara, wanting to check how observant she is, and she asks Klara to mimic the way her daughter walks • the Mother is presented as being determined to provide the best possible life for her daughter. It is for this reason that she decided to have Josie 'lifted', which is a procedure that is supposed to make children more intelligent and better prepared for their future, although potentially it has fatal side effects. Chrissie, the Mother, wants her daughter to be able to attend one of the selective colleges • later in the novel, it is revealed that Josie's mother had another daughter, named Sal, who died of a disease at a young age. It is, perhaps, for this reason that Chrissie is particularly concerned when Josie falls ill • the Mother makes a plan with Mr Capaldi that, if Josie dies, Klara should become a new Josie, even though she is not sure that she will be able to love her the same • when Josie's health deteriorates, Josie's mother, along with Rick and Klara, keep her company, clearly concerned about her wellbeing. Klara recalls how 'the Mother thought if she stayed with Josie all the time, Josie would be less lonely'. Josie's mother is so dedicated to her daughter that she even offers to give up her job so that she can stay by her side • when the Mother believes that Josie is not going to live, there are indications that she blames herself. She questions Rick, 'I'm asking you, Rick, if you feel like you've come out the winner', aware that Josie's illness is the result of her own decision to have her daughter 'lifted' • it is clear that Josie loves her mother dearly. Believing Josie to be nearing death, Rick shares Josie's words with her mother: 'she loves you and will always love you. She's very grateful you're her mother and she never even once wished for another' • Josie's mother is presented as not wanting to get her hopes up when Josie shows signs of recovering from her illness. The Mother says 'Okay, let's assume nothing ... We have to take this one step at a time' • the Mother is presented as having a rather distant relationship with her ex-husband and Josie's father, 'the Father'. Towards the end of the novel, when the decision is being made about the college Josie is to attend, Klara recalls 'It was the only time I saw him come to the house' • following Josie's recovery, Mr Capaldi arrives at the house with the intention of prizing Klara open to gain a better understanding of how AFs function.

However, the Mother is presented as protective of Klara. She tells Mr Capaldi 'Leave our Klara be. Let her have her slow fade', and she is described as stepping in front of Klara to protect her from him. However, Klara ends up in the scrapyard, presumably abandoned by the Mother.

(AO4)

- when Ishiguro was writing the novel, it is thought that he considered the recent Cripsr developments in gene editing, which have already been used to cure sickle cell and other blood related illnesses, to reflect on the possibilities of how this could be used in the future, particularly if the industry is not sufficiently regulated
- in the society of the unspecified time the novel is set, thought to be in the not-too-distant future, it is believed that biological artificial intelligence can be used to improve the intelligence of humans. Josie's mother is, arguably, acting with good intentions in getting her 'lifted' so that she has more opportunities in life
- it is apparent that Josie's mother is in a comfortable position in life. She is able to afford a housekeeper and buys her daughter an AF. Although there are suggestions that such AFs would likely be accessible to many, only the richest would be able to afford the best models
- indeed, the fact that Josie's mother can afford to have her 'lifted' serves to highlight social divisions in society. Rick does not come from a wealthy family, and they cannot afford to have him lifted.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
15 <i>Klara and the Sun</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Rick initially believes that he and Josie can spend their lives together but later loses faith in his and Josie's 'plan' coming to fruition. However, there are many examples of characters maintaining faith in the novel, particularly Klara's complete faith in the Sun. Other examples include Manager's faith in Klara as an excellent Artificial Friend (AF) • early in the novel, Josie and Rick both have faith in the fact that they will remain close throughout their lives. When Josie first talks about Rick, she tells Klara 'we're going to spend our lives together'. Later, however, when Klara questions Rick about their 'plan', he tells her that it was a plan that they started when they were young, before they realised 'how it would be'. There are signs that Rick has less faith in the plan than Josie does when he says to Klara 'Even so, Josie still believes in it' • later, it becomes clear that Josie's faith has been blind in her plan with Rick. The reader learns that Josie has been 'lifted', a procedure that is supposed to make children more intelligent and better prepared for their future, which means that she is in a position to go to one of the selective colleges. However, as Rick has not been 'lifted', he does not have the same opportunities available to him as Josie does, which will separate the two • at the start of the novel, when Rosa and Klara are new AFs, Boy AF Rex emphasises the importance of having faith in the Sun. He tells them that it would be able to reach them wherever they are: 'If you're worried, you can just touch it and get strong again' • Klara has steadfast faith in the Sun's healing powers, and it is a source of companionship for her throughout the novel. As a solar-powered AF, nourishment is provided by the Sun to her, but Klara also believes that the Sun can have a similar effect on humans. When the Beggar Man stops moving, and Klara believes him to be dead, he appears to be resurrected the next morning when the Sun rises • having returned from the city with Klara and her parents, Josie's health begins to deteriorate. When Rick becomes particularly concerned about Josie, Klara tries to give him faith in the fact that she will recover. She tells him there is 'reason to hope'. Klara, determined to do what she can to help Josie, travels, with Rick's aid, to Mr McBain's barn, where she pleads with the Sun to help Josie. Later, Klara reflects how the 'Sun's special nourishment proved as effective for Josie as it had for Beggar Man' • at the end of the novel, when Manager visits the yard and sees Klara, it is clear that Klara's faith in the Sun is unwavering. Klara concludes the conversation by saying 'I must report to you ... The Sun was very kind to me. He was always kind to me from the start' • Manager, the human who runs the AF store, has faith in Klara as an AF. In the shop, she recognises how observant Klara is, telling her 'you're quite

	remarkable'. Towards the end of the novel, when Manager meets Klara in the yard, she reiterates the faith she had in Klara as an AF: 'Of all the AFs I looked after, you were certainly one of the most remarkable' - the Mother demonstrates a lack of faith in Josie's recovery, making a plan with Mr Capaldi that, if Josie dies, Klara should become a new Josie. (AO4) - initially, Rick has complete faith in his future relationship with Josie, describing their love as 'genuine and forever'. This is presented in direct contrast to Klara's own acceptance that, as an AF, her transience means that she is unable to have such life-long connections - the novel could be considered a critique of the idea of having any kind of faith, particularly as Klara's faith in the Sun is based on a misunderstanding - nevertheless, the novel offers a message about the importance of faith as a way of providing hope. For example, Rick tells Klara how he thought her actions, such as going to Mr McBain's barn, as 'AF superstition. Something just to bring us good luck'. He goes on to admit, however, how he keeps 'wondering if there was more to it' - indeed, in different cultures, the Sun is considered a sign of hope and an opportunity for new beginnings.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
16 Western Lane	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - romantic love is a prominent theme throughout the novel. There are examples of romantic love in adult relationships, but, while the girls are growing up, they, too, develop romantic feelings - when the family visit Edinburgh early in the novel, Uncle Pavan tries to support his brother by reminding him of the happy times he had with his wife, Bapuji: 'Do you remember? The night you told Bapuji you were getting married'. This suggests that Pa and Ma were in a loving relationship, and it is Pa's sadness at the loss of his wife that is central to the narrative - indeed, there are signs that Pa is truly heartbroken by the loss of his wife. Initially, he keeps himself busy with work all the time but, as the novel progresses, he starts to tell people he is too busy or simply does not turn up to appointments. Later in the novel, when Gopi asks him directly 'Do you remember Ma?', Pa does not reply. He turns up the volume on the television and he sits with Gopi in silence - Pa does find some solace in Ged's mother, Linda. They spend time talking together when smoking and he feels able to confide his private terrors to her, which he does not to anyone else. She also tends to Pa's injury when Gopi hits him during a game of squash. However, there are no signs in the novel that this relationship develops into a romantic one - Gopi's and Mona's growing interest in boys is evidence of how they are becoming more emotionally mature. When thinking about the people she met at Western Lane, Gopi reflects 'there were a few occasional players, and then there was Ged'. It becomes clear that Gopi develops an interest in Ged, thinking about him when she is not at the club and, later, being able to talk to him off the squash court. When questioned by Khush, Gopi reluctantly admits that she thinks 'He's okay' - it becomes apparent that Ged helps Gopi overcome feelings of loss of her mother. She describes an occasion at Western Lane, when the courts were occupied, where she is standing next to Ged: 'I stopped thinking of Ma. The world seemed big and luminous'. Later, she is disappointed when Ged's mother says that she is not allowed to play squash with him, after Gopi injures her father with a hard-hit ball while playing - in a similar way to how her sister feels about Ged, Mona is immediately taken by Shaan, Masqud's nephew, when she first meets him at Western Lane. Gopi describes how, previously, Mona was never really interested in playing squash: 'There was a sullenness about her, a tightness in her muscles, and a refusal of ease or rhythm in her movement'. However, following Shaan's arrival, Gopi describes how Mona 'looked like a different player suddenly. Her racket was up and she was stepping into her swing'. Mona also suddenly becomes interested in going to the tournament at Durham and Cleveland, aware that Masqud will be there

- however, following the incident at the fair, when Mona realises Shaan is interested in another girl, she becomes withdrawn. She stops working at the salon and rarely leaves the house
- later, Mona shows her growing maturity when she admits the difficulties she would have faced as a Jain dating a Pakistani boy. It is the thought of what Ma would say, even though she is dead, that prevents Mona from telling Shaan how she feels about him: 'what about the shame on Ma, who was gone?'
- towards the end of the novel, when Gopi sees Ged at the squash tournament, she describes how Ged 'looked different'. Any romance between them is thwarted because of her move to Edinburgh, but Gopi also admits 'We were shy and afraid because there was all this feeling between us and we didn't know who we were'
- candidates might also consider the relationship between Aunt Ranjan and Uncle Pavan. Although there is little evidence of any warmth in their relationship, it becomes clear that they are close, such as the way Uncle Pavan knows how to talk to his wife in order for her to allow Gopi to attend the tournament.

(AO4)

- the trials and tribulations of teenage romance are central to this coming-of-age novel, which is a popular genre in the current day
- Maroo is believed to have written the novel to, at least in part, address the challenges of growing up in a multicultural society
- the dynamics in the relationship between Uncle Pavan and his wife, Aunt Ranjan, in that he has to use indirect methods to achieve his own way, go against the generally expected gender roles of a British Gujarati husband and wife relationship, particularly at the time. For example, Uncle Pavan has to persuade Aunt Ranjan to let Gopi go to the squash tournament
- Mona does not tell Shaan how she feels about him, partly because she is worried that Aunt Ranjan would complain about her 'going around with a Pakistani boy'. This reflects how a Jain's entering a relationship with, and marrying, someone of another religion could meet with disapproval.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	• Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. • There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. • Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	• Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. • There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. • Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	• Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. • Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. • Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
17 Western Lane	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Khush is presented as being close to her two sisters, but, particularly as the novel progresses, there are signs that she is struggling to cope with the death of her mother • it is revealed early in the novel that Khush was 13 when her mother died. She is the middle sibling of the three sisters • when the family visit Uncle Pavan and Aunt Ranjan in Edinburgh, Khush is presented as rather distant, 'staring out of the window' • indeed, early in the novel, Khush is presented as a character not comfortable with sharing her emotions with her wider family. When Aunt Ranjan thinks back to Ma's funeral, she describes how Khush was 'crying silently' in the car park • however, Khush is presented as having a close sisterly bond with both Gopi and Mona. When the girls sleep in the same room in Edinburgh, Gopi observes how open and talkative her sister is: 'It was Khush who did the telling'. Later, Gopi presents Khush as someone who does not hide her feelings from her sisters. Gopi describes Khush's face as 'Heart-shaped and open' with her emotions 'close to the surface', and, when moved, 'her eyes filled with tears' • Khush provides support to her sisters following the death of their mother. She reassures Gopi: 'Things are going to be okay' • nevertheless, it does become apparent that Khush grows apart from her sisters. Gopi notices how Khush has become 'preoccupied', no longer listening to the radio or reading, and spending time outside the girls' bedroom in the dark, late at night • it soon becomes clear that Khush is affected the most out of the three sisters by their mother's death. She thinks back to memories of her mother during her childhood and behaves in a way her mother would have done: 'Khush came in with a plate of digestive biscuits with slices of orange arranged on top. It was what Ma used to bring us'. Khush is also heard talking to her mother late at night in Gujarati in the hallway. Gopi reflects 'We weren't sure, but it sounded to us like Khush was trying to get to Ma' • although Khush is no longer open about her emotions with her sisters, she continues to be presented as a supportive sister. When Gopi experiences physical changes to her body, she seeks the support of Khush, who helps Gopi by using her emergency coins to 'get a pad from the machine'. The sisterly bond is central to their ability to cope with the challenge of growing up without their mother • when Khush learns that Gopi is to go to live with Aunt Ranjan and Uncle Pavan, she is presented as being protective of her sister. Khush says 'It doesn't matter what you did ... You don't have to go with them'. It is clear that Khush will miss her sister and does not want her to leave

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| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• towards the end of the novel, Khush goes to watch Gopi take part in the squash tournament. It is clear from their interactions that they have a close bond, which is able to withstand the physical separation they have endured. Gopi explains how her sister grabbed her hand for reassurance. |
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(AO4)

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| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• throughout the novel, there are instances where characters, including Khush, are thought to be talking to Ma. This is, perhaps, representative of the belief in Jainism that the body is just an inanimate container whereas the soul exists for ever• the girls mostly speak English but they are expected to attend Gujarati school, which is in part to maintain this side of their identity as they grow up. This also enables Khush to be able to talk to Ma in Gujarati after Ma's passing• Maroo is believed to have written the novel to, at least in part, address the challenges of growing up in a multicultural society• Jainism does not place any age restriction on the attainment of spiritual maturity. At points in the novel, Khush demonstrates a level of maturity atypical of her chronological age. |
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	- Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. - Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	- Some knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. - Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	- Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. - There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. - Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	- Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. - There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. - Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	- Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. - Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. - Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.